

PET Study Guide

Paul Christian and Nancy M. Swanston

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The third edition of *PET Study Guide*, authored by Paul Christian and Nancy Swanston, is an invaluable resource for anyone preparing for the PET certification exam. Although created mainly for the exam, this book serves a broader purpose than just test preparation as it is an excellent resource for seasoned technologists. This current edition builds on the strengths of its predecessors, offering an updated and comprehensive quick reference that effectively covers the key concepts and practices necessary for success in the use of PET in the field of nuclear medicine.

The guide is well structured and is based on the content outline for the Nuclear Medicine Technology Certification Board PET examination. The authors have wisely incorporated student feedback over the years, refining the guide to enhance learning. The authors have done an excellent job of breaking down complex topics into digestible sections, making the material accessible even for those who may be new to PET.

This 260-page book is arranged into 14 chapters, with concise learning objectives laid out at the very beginning. Each chapter is logically organized, with clear headings and subheadings that make it easy to follow. The book begins with an introduction to the principles of PET radiopharmaceutical production, followed by chapters on instrumentation, imaging protocols, and radiation safety, to name a few. Additionally, the guide is filled with high-quality images and diagrams that visually reinforce the textual information. At the end of each chapter is a variety of practice questions and exercises that mimic the style

and difficulty of those found on the actual PET certification exam. There is also a section of additional suggested reading at the end of each chapter to support continued learning. The authors' emphasis on understanding the material, rather than just memorizing it, is an approach that encourages deeper learning and long-term retention.

The third edition is particularly commendable for its updates, reflecting the latest advancements in PET technology and clinical practices. This ensures that readers not only are prepared for the exam but also are also up to date with current industry standards. The authors have included not only isotopes that are already Food and Drug Administration-approved but also some that were in current clinical trials at the time of publication. The authors do warn, however, that because the field of nuclear medicine is constantly evolving, the responsibility falls on the learner to always seek out the newest, most accurate information.

Overall, *PET Study Guide* is a top-tier resource for anyone preparing for the PET certification exam. Its comprehensive coverage, practical exam preparation tools, and up-to-date information make it an essential addition to any nuclear medicine professional's library. Whether you are new to the field or looking to update your knowledge, this guide is sure to be a valuable asset in your preparation and ongoing professional development.

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